

film review Eyes Tight Shut

ONE TWO THREE

Director: Ashwani Dhir
Starring: Paresh Rawal,
Tushar Kapoor, Suniel
Shetty

The new kind of Bollywood comedy usually thrives on sex or toilet jokes. This is a movie which takes the formula literally, with a sexually explicit joke staged in the toilet. Rawal plays a salesman of women's lingerie, which naturally lends itself to all manner of lewd anatomical jokes, while Neetu Chandra plays Mayawati Chautala, a policewoman with an



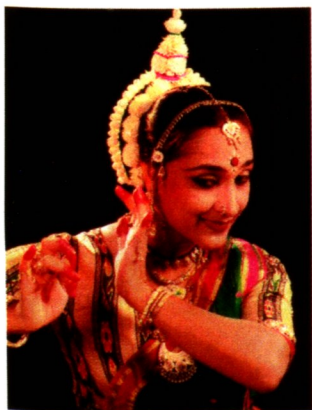
THICK AND FAST: The film spearheads the silly season

over-active libido and Kapoor plays a wannabe gangster. All of which leads one to believe that the actors must have listened to one-line narrations of their parts, closed their eyes and thought of the pay cheques. There appears to be no other reason why a film like this

should get made—apart from allowing for lots of short skirts and deep cleavage to be exhibited. The greater worry? We're moving into a silly season where such "naughty" comedies with 'star' character actors are going to flow thick and fast. Sigh. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

recommendations Assorted Weave

DELHI Unbound Beats of India, the international festival of dance and music, opens with a Didjeridu recital by Ameet Gauhar from the UK and a Kuchipudi dance performance by Bettina Bresse from Germany. Ranjana Gauhar presents an Odissi recital by Durga Arya. The second day will have a veena recital by Saraswati Rajgopalan, Bharatnat-Gauhar's Odissi recital



TRAVEL BUG: Maity's interpretation of God's Own Country

yam by Pratiba Prahlad and Odissi by Ramli Ibrahim and January Low from Malaysia. At India Habitat Centre, April 8-9.

DELHI Paresh Maity turns his 2007 Kerala visit into an interpretation of God's Own Country. His works are a travelogue capturing colourful Kathakali dancers, decorated elephants, boats, deep-blue waters and endless green pastures. Also on display are photographs by Nemai Ghosh who accompanied Maity. At Art Alive Gallery till April 19.

BANGALORE The Goethe Institute and Max Mueller Bhavan present the exhibition The World As One of the German Institut für Auslandsbeziehungen e.V. (ifa)/Institute for Foreign Cultural Relations. This is another in a series on documentary photography with more than 250 works from 19 artists featuring photographs from Germany post-1989. The exhibition opens in Bangalore before travelling all over India. From April 5-19 at the Karnataka Chitrakala Parishatha.

music review Winning Hit



Sony-BMG
Rs 160

JANNAT
Music
composer
Pritam has
perfected
the art of
doling out hit

after hit in Bollywood. First it was *Gangster*, then *Woh Lamhe*, *Awarapan* and now *Jannat*. He has a way of extracting the best from singers, using it to create that perfect harmonic sound with his imaginative orchestration interspersed with rhythmic wonders.

The first song, *Zara e by KK*, is a sure winner with all the elements of a great melody—a good voice with immaculate modulation and the right arrangement. The song is uncannily similar to *Tu he mera shab* from *Gangster*. After Kishore Kumar, KK has that pensive quality that endears his voice as he sings a power ballad. Kamran Ahmed—who has sung as well as composed *Judai*, reminiscent of Reshma's *Lambi Judai* in the film *Hero*—starts with a slow pitch but gains in tempo and intensity like a rock ballad. *Jannat jahan* by Rupam Islam, the lead singer of Fossils, also incorporates the rock feel in the song. A surprise element in the album is Rana Mazumdar's *Door na ja*, a trifle melodramatic with a slow start, but Pritam's music saves it from floundering.

An impressive element is Niladri Kumar's zitar—which combines the guitar and sitar to produce a new and eclectic sound with scintillating interludes. Lyricist Sayed Qadri (who also wrote the lyrics for *Life In A... Metro* and *Jism*) has come up with well-written lyrics in an album that has all the ingredients of a potential chartbuster.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit